Cranial Nerves (V, VII, IX, X, XII & Overview): Set 1 (Easy Recall)

1. Cranial Nerve V (Trigeminal) emerges from the lateral aspect of the pons via a large sensory root and a small motor root. Which specialized peripheral ganglion contains the cell bodies for its sensory branches?
a. Ciliary ganglion
b. Otic ganglion
c. Pterygopalatine ganglion
d. Trigeminal (Semilunar / Gasserian) ganglion
e. Geniculate ganglion
2. The trigeminal nerve splits into three major divisions. The ophthalmic division (V1) exits the middle cranial fossa to enter the orbit by passing through the:
a. Foramen rotundum
b. Foramen ovale
c. Superior orbital fissure
d. Foramen spinosum
e. Optic canal
3. The maxillary division (V2) of the trigeminal nerve passes forward from the trigeminal ganglion and exits the cranium through which specific opening?
a. Foramen rotundum
b. Foramen ovale
c. Superior orbital fissure
d. Stylomastoid foramen
e. Foramen lacerum
4. The mandibular division (V3) carries both sensory and motor fibers. It exits the base of the skull vertically by traveling through the:
a. Foramen rotundum
b. Foramen ovale
c. Foramen spinosum
d. Jugular foramen
e. Stylomastoid foramen
5. Cranial Nerve VII (Facial) enters the petrous part of the temporal bone via the internal acoustic meatus but exits the base of the skull into the neck through the:
a. Foramen ovale
b. Stylomastoid foramen
c. Jugular foramen
d. Foramen lacerum
e. Petro-occipital fissure
6. After exiting the skull, the main motor trunk of the facial nerve passes directly into the parenchyma of which major salivary gland before dividing into its terminal branches?
a. Parotid gland
b. Submandibular gland
c. Sublingual gland
d. Von Ebner gland
e. Lacrimal gland

7. A cluster of three cranial nerves exits the skull together through the jugular foramen. Which of these is Cranial Nerve IX, responsible for supplying the stylopharyngeus muscle?
a. Accessory nerve
b. Vagus nerve
c. Glossopharyngeal nerve
d. Facial nerve
e. Hypoglossal nerve
8. Cranial Nerve X (Vagus) has the longest course of any cranial nerve, descending through the neck inside which fascial structure?
a. Pretracheal fascia
b. Prevertebral fascia
c. Investing layer sleeve
d. Carotid sheath
e. Buccopharyngeal layer
9. Cranial Nerve XII (Hypoglossal) provides motor control to the muscles of the tongue. It leaves the posterior cranial fossa by passing through the:
a. Hypoglossal canal
b. Jugular foramen
c. Foramen magnum
d. Foramen rotundum
e. Condylar canal
10. An injury to Cranial Nerve XII (Hypoglossal nerve palsy) compromises the tongue muscles on the affected side. When the patient is asked to protrude their tongue, it will characteristically deviate:
a. Toward the normal, healthy side
b. Alternating side to side automatically
c. Upward toward the palate
d. Toward the paralyzed, injured side
e. Backward into the pharynx
11. Let's briefly touch on the other nerves. Cranial Nerve I (Olfactory) mediates the special sense of smell. Its delicate nerve bundles pass upward into the anterior cranial fossa through the:
a. Optic canal
b. Cribriform plate of the ethmoid bone
c. Foramen cecum
d. Superior orbital fissure
e. Sphenopalatine foramen
12. Cranial Nerve II (Optic) carries visual information from the neural retina to the brain. It enters the middle cranial fossa from the orbit via the:
a. Optic canal
b. Superior orbital fissure
c. Inferior orbital fissure
d. Foramen rotundum
e. Scleral cribriform plate
13. Cranial Nerves III (Oculomotor), IV (Trochlear), and VI (Abducens) control the extraocular muscles. They all exit the cranial cavity to reach the orbit via the:
a. Optic canal

b. Inferior orbital fissure
c. Superior orbital fissure
d. Foramen rotundum
e. Foramen ovale

14. Cranial Nerve VIII (Vestibulocochlear) carries the special somatic afferent pathways for balance and hearing. It enters the petrous temporal bone through the:

a. Foramen lacerum
b. Internal acoustic meatus
c. External acoustic meatus
d. Jugular foramen
e. Stylomastoid foramen

15. Cranial Nerve XI (Spinal Accessory) supplies motor fibers to the sternocleidomastoid and trapezius muscles. It leaves the cranium alongside nerves IX and X through the:

a. Foramen magnum
b. Hypoglossal canal
c. Jugular foramen
d. Stylomastoid foramen
e. Foramen spinosum

16. Complete lower motor neuron paralysis of the facial nerve (CN VII) causes a total loss of movement in the muscles of facial expression on one side of the face, a condition known as:

a. Trigeminal neuralgia
b. Horner's syndrome
c. Bell's palsy
d. Frey's syndrome
e. Tic douloureux

17. Trigeminal neuralgia is a severe, high-yield clinical condition affecting CN V. It is characterized by:

a. Loss of taste on the posterior tongue
b. Flaccid paralysis of the lips
c. Sudden, excruciating paroxysms of sharp, stabbing pain along the distribution of V2 or V3
d. Complete dropping of the upper eyelid
e. Numbness over the mastoid process skin

18. Cranial Nerve IX (Glossopharyngeal) carries special visceral afferent fibers for taste. It supplies taste sensation to which region of the tongue?

a. Anterior one-third
b. Posterior one-third (including the circumvallate papillae)
c. Tip of the tongue only
d. Lateral margins of the anterior two-thirds
e. Ventral surface mucosa

19. The recurrent laryngeal nerve is a crucial branch of Cranial Nerve X (Vagus). Injury to this nerve results in paralysis of most intrinsic muscles of the larynx, presenting clinically as:

a. Loss of general sensation on the tongue
b. Hoarseness of the voice
c. Inability to shrug the shoulders
d. Drooping of the corner of the mouth

e. Deviated uvula

20. When testing the pupillary light reflex, shining light into one eye causes constriction of both pupils. The afferent limb of this reflex is carried by CN II (Optic), while the efferent motor limb is mediated by:

a. CN III (Oculomotor nerve parasympathetic fibers)
b. CN IV (Trochlear nerve)
c. CN VI (Abducens nerve)
d. CN V1 (Ophthalmic nerve)
e. CN VII (Facial nerve)